CREW ONE-PAGER

Run of show · 1:30 to 3:00

Ninety minutes, hard stop. Four equal stations, a video after each, snack together at the end. The video is the transition signal: lights dim, everyone watches, everyone moves.

1:00	Floater arrives. Door tape, candles, cauldron, badge table.
1:05	Station leads arrive, set their bins. Detective tests projector, timer, and all four videos with sound.
1:15	**Huddle** (see below). Hand out station cards and envelopes.
1:30	**Entrance and hook (8 min).** Lights off, one LED candle per station, wind loop. The Detective's opening. Kids arrive wearing their squad wristband (1 purple, 2 black, 3 teal, 4 orange). Chief hands each squad a numbered case file. Squads to the station with their number. Lights to "dim."
1:38	**Rotation 1 (11 min).** Timer on the projector. At the bell, leads hand over the sealed CLUE envelope.
1:49	**Video 1: The Principal (2 min).** "Did I say squishies?" Detective pulls the evidence-bag squishy. Chief: "Candy-adjacent." "Cross out candy. Write squishies. Rotate."
1:51	**Rotation 2.** Leads switch to saying "squishies."
2:02	**Video 2: The Reading Specialist.** "I just don't understand the obsession these days." Rotate.
2:04	**Rotation 3.** Floater hides the 20 evidence tags.
2:15	**Video 3: The Librarian.** "Check their feet." Rotate.
2:17	**Rotation 4.** Every squad now holds four clues. Leads pack during the last two minutes.
2:28	**Deliberation, warrants, snack (12 min).** Lights up. Squads compare clues and write the arrest warrant. When a squad has crossed off all four, the Detective produces the Chief's statement form from the folder and pins it to the board: it matches every clue. Warrants in the cauldron. Snack by squad if approved. Wanted Poster table open.
2:40	**Warrants read, Video 4: The Confession (5 min).** Detective reads each accusation. Chief protests. "There is one more statement." She cracks on camera.
2:45	**Lights out, hunt, the Jar (10 min).** Announce it first. Three blacklights per squad, three-minute hunt, every detective finds one tag. Lights up. The Chief carries the Jar out. Tape off, lid off, squishies. One tag, one squishy.
2:55	**Land it.** Certificates from the Chief. Group photo. Short spooky read-aloud while volunteers strike. Class handed back calm at 3:00.

Rotation grid

Squad	1:38	1:51	2:04	2:17	Last one standing
Squad 1	1	2	3	4	Reading Specialist
Squad 2	2	3	4	1	Librarian
Squad 3	3	4	1	2	Principal
Squad 4	4	1	2	3	Custodian

1 Evidence Lab · 2 Ghostbuster Lab · 3 Cipher Room · 4 Mummy Witness. A squad's number is its first station; after 4 comes 1. Each squad's final station clears a different suspect, so no two squads have the same "aha" moment.

Room map



Loud stations (2 and 4) in opposite corners. Calm stations (1 and 3) between them.

Crew

Role	Who	Arrives	Owns
The Detective	Room parent	12:45	MC, opening, timer, plays each video at the bell, finale, certificates. Runs no station.
The Chief	Teacher	—	Sorts the squads a week out, holds allergy and photo lists, records Video 4, one live line after Video 1, outrage when accused, certificates, lit-zone adult during lights-out.
Station 1 lead	_____	1:05	Evidence Lab
Station 2 lead	_____	1:05	Ghostbuster Lab. Makes or receives the 25 ghosts.
Station 3 lead	_____	1:10	Cipher Room
Station 4 lead	_____	1:05	Mummy Witness. Gets wrapped four times.
Floater / photographer	_____	1:00	Door, badges, restocks, photos, hides the 20 tags, runs the squishy trade.
Cleanup crew (2)	_____	2:55	Strike stations, trash out, tablecloths tossed.

Huddle · 1:15, ten minutes

1. Walk the rotation order and the room map. Point to the timer on the projector.
2. Show how the videos play (laptop, volume up, lights dim on the Floater's cue).
3. Confirm each lead has four CLUE envelopes for their station, one per squad.
4. Say "candy" until Video 1 has played; "squishies" after. The Chief's one live line: "Candy. ...Mostly. Candy-adjacent."
5. Teacher points out allergy kids, photo opt-outs, and the kid who may need a job (timer deputy, evidence courier, Dispatcher).
6. Agree on the bell and the lights-out announcement ("in one minute the lights go off for three minutes").
7. Bathroom coverage: pairs, Floater escorts.
8. Hand out bins. Leads to stations. Detective to the door.

If things slip

- **Running long:** cut rotation 4 to 8 minutes, not the deliberation. The warrants are the point.
- **Video won't play:** the Detective reads the script aloud in character. Keep the title card on screen.
- **Room won't go dark:** tags go in a dark box; squads take turns with the blacklights.
- **Only two volunteers:** three stations (Evidence Lab and Cipher Room merge under the Chief), three 14-minute rotations, Librarian video opens deliberation.